

James Peel

Senior Product Designer

Education

University of Sussex
Product Design, BSc
First Class Honours

Introduction

I am a senior product designer at Xeneta, leading design on flagship initiatives that shape the world's leading freight intelligence platform, translating complex global data into experiences that inform critical decisions for the world's largest brands. Previously, I worked within Amazon's Global Transportation Technology organisation, contributing to the design of systems that power and optimise one of the largest logistics networks in the world. I also held consulting roles at IBM and Cognizant, delivering solutions across healthcare, government, hospitality, and large-scale enterprise environments.

Experience

Senior Product Designer @ Xeneta Aug 2024 - Now

Xeneta is the global leader in real-time ocean and air freight rate benchmarking and market analytics, trusted by logistics giants like Walmart, Amazon, Coca-Cola, Maersk, and Nestlé. With over 700 million crowdsourced rates and 170,000 trade lanes, Xeneta empowers the world's largest shippers and carriers to make data-driven, confident supply chain decisions. As a Senior Product Designer leading design on Xeneta's most strategic initiatives, I shape product strategy and user experience that turn this vast data ecosystem into clear, actionable insight, driving innovation, simplifying complexity, and ensuring every decision our users make delivers measurable impact.

Senior User Experience Design Consultant @ Cognizant Jan 2023 - Aug 2024

Cognizant Digital, a division of one of the world's largest consulting firms with multi-billion-dollar revenue, provides cutting-edge digital solutions across various industries. As a Senior Consultant, I led design efforts on key accounts in the public sector and hospitality, developing user-centered solutions that streamlined operations and enhanced customer experiences. The strategies and products I delivered resulted in significant improvements in efficiency and satisfaction for our clients.

User Experience Designer @ Amazon Jun 2021 - Jan 2023

Amazon's transportation network is so large, complex, and growing that it is no longer manageable by human operators alone. Amazon needed to build technology to scale and run its network by automating tasks and decision-making. I joined as the first designer on the team, with a goal to bring a design-centred culture to an engineering-led org. I helped establish GTTX, the experience design function within GTTS, shipping products like Umbrella that saved Amazon over \$250 million in its first year. As the function grew, I took on broader design leadership, working alongside senior designers and PMs to shape a pipeline of logistics automation products.

User Experience Designer @ IBM Jul 2019 - Aug 2020

I worked as a UX and UI design consultant at IBM iX, a worldwide business design consultancy in their London Southbank office. I worked on projects across healthcare, sports, education, and entertainment industries. Acting as a consultant highlighted the importance of soft skills and the breadth of required technical capabilities and knowledge, ranging from agile delivery methods to complex application architecture.

Key Projects

Index-Linked Freight Contracts @ Xeneta

Global shipping is a massive, complex market, and traditional contract models have long struggled with price volatility and limited transparency. Xeneta's index-linked approach is redefining how freight is priced across the entire industry. As the lead designer for this initiative, I created the educational simulator and in-platform workflows that leverage real-time market data, enabling shipping companies and cargo owners to mitigate risk and optimize costs. By driving this data-driven transformation, I helped position Xeneta as the critical force in modernizing global freight pricing models, earning the Ship Technology Innovation Award 2025 for innovation in ocean freight contracting.

Umbrella @ Amazon

Amazon aims to control and automate almost all parts of its logistics network; however, there is one part it can never control: the weather. My team, Global Transportation Technology Services, was tasked with creating a new way of monitoring the logistics network and protecting customers in the case of adverse weather. Umbrella is a transportation network weather monitoring, forecasting, and automatic padding tool that helps protect Amazon's delivery estimate accuracy while increasing speed. I worked as the lead UX designer on this project, creating an experience that is highly intuitive for all user personas. Following launch, Umbrella saved Amazon over 250 million dollars in its first year by improving delivery accuracy and operational efficiency.

The Official Liverpool Football Club App @ IBM

Liverpool Football Club approached my team at IBM to create the future of digital experiences for millions of fans worldwide. We developed two new apps – the Official LFC app and LFCTVGO, which launched in October. I took responsibility for conducting user research workshops and usability testing of wireframes to validate designs. I led the creation and maintenance of atomic design libraries. Moreover, I curated LFC Design – a tailored internal design system and a single source of truth for everything digitally designed for LFC. The Official LFC App has 2M+ downloads across the Android and Apple app stores.

University of the Arts London Virtual Graduate Showcase @ IBM

When COVID-19 made traditional graduate shows impossible, the University of the Arts London (UAL), ranked number two globally for art and design, faced a critical challenge. With over 7,000 students across six colleges preparing to exhibit their work, cancellation was not an option. I was brought in to lead UI design for IBM as part of the UAL x IBM Graduate Showcase initiative, creating a digital platform that reimaged how students could share their work with the world. The platform launched successfully, helping thousands of graduates secure employment and industry recognition, and remains in use today as a signature digital showcase and a unique selling point for UAL's global recruitment.

Greene King Bookings @ Cognizant

The UK loves pubs, and at the forefront stands Greene King – the largest and most iconic brand with over 3,600 establishments. During my time at Cognizant, I led UX design for Greene King Pubs, tackling the challenge of redesigning the end-to-end booking journey across pubs of all sizes with diverse accommodation options. Research was central, engaging both customers and bar staff to address varied needs while navigating outdated point-of-sale systems. A key achievement was launching a large-party booking feature, which streamlined the process and boosted engagement. We also ensured inclusivity, making it possible for every customer, regardless of access needs, to book with ease and enjoy a great experience.